SHOC SOPs 4

Emergency Response Team (ERT) SOPs

Mobilisation, deployment, reporting, logistics, and transboundary operations.

SADC Humanitarian Emergency Operations Centre, Nacala, Mozambique

SADC HUMANITARIAN AND EMERGENCY OPERATIONS CENTRE

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURES

EMERGENCY RESPONSE TEAMS

Activation | Mobilisation | In-Country Operations | Transition & Demobilisation | Transboundary Cooperation

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SOVEREIGNTY SAFEGUARD: SHOC does not substitute for national response capacity. Emergency Response Teams operate in support of, and under the operational authority of, the designated National Disaster Management Authorities of Member States. Deployment of physical assets and operational command remain under national sovereign authority at all times.

Written for: The SHOC ERT Coordinator (Head of Operations or designee) as the primary operational reference for managing the end-to-end ERT deployment cycle from the SHOC Situation Room. Every section maps to specific SHOC ERT Portal transactions.

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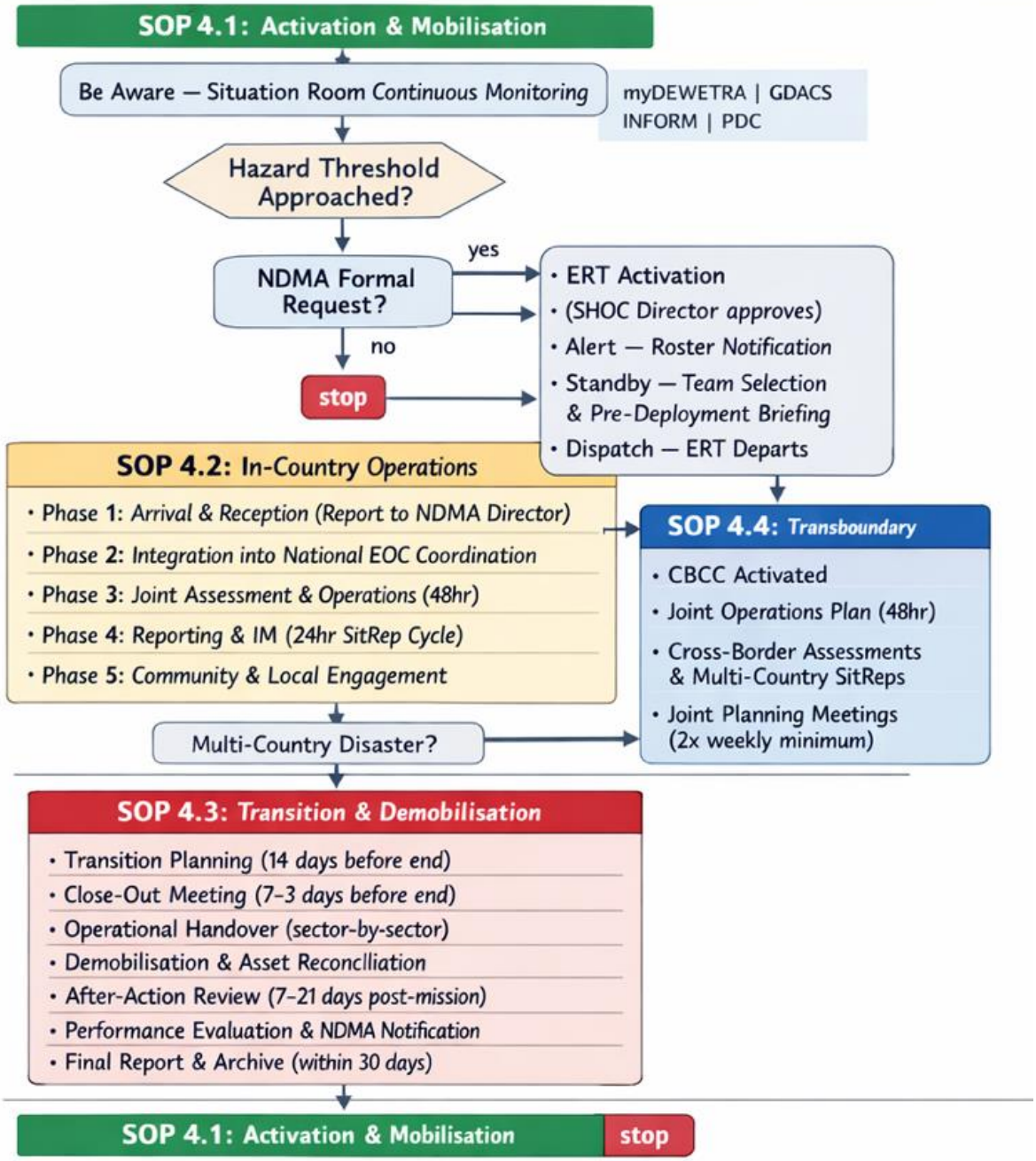
Master ERT Mission Lifecycle

The following diagram illustrates the complete ERT mission lifecycle showing how all four SOPs connect in a continuous operational cycle, from initial hazard monitoring through to post-mission knowledge management and SOP revision.



Introduction

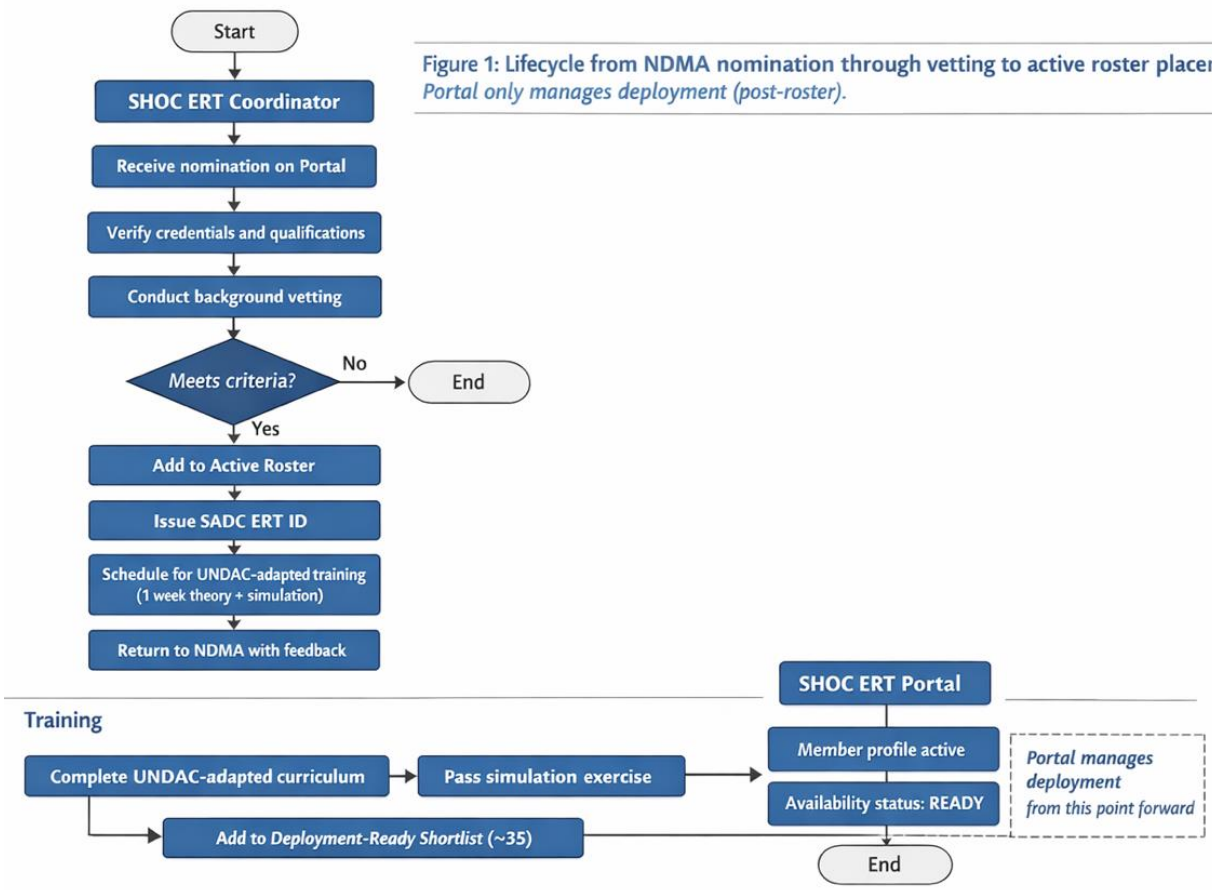


Figure 1: Lifecycle from NDMA nomination through vetting to active roster placement. *Portal only manages deployment (post-roster).*

This SOP establishes the operational framework governing the activation, mobilisation, coordination, and support of SADC ERTs within the SHOC coordination architecture.

The SOP is grounded in the legal and institutional framework of SADC and the MOA with Member States, aligned with the UNDAC Mission Cycle (8th Edition, Chapter C). It clarifies that ERTs operate in support of the designated NDMAs. Deployment and operational command remain under national sovereign authority.

Where a disaster affects more than one Member State, multi-country coordination is integrated at each stage through the Cross-Border Coordination Cell (CBCC) procedures defined in TRANSBOUNDARY COOPERATION, with in-country transboundary protocols embedded in IN- COUNTRY OPERATIONS PROTOCOL.

SHOC Mission Cycle (Aligned to UNDAC 8th Edition)

SHOC uses descriptive phase names rather than alphanumeric codes to ensure clarity across diverse national capacities and language contexts:

Phase	UNDAC Equiv.	Description
Watch	Pre-Mission (M0)	Continuous monitoring; no deployment action. Situation Room maintains hazard surveillance and verifies conditions with NDMAs.
Alert	Alert (M1)	Alert issued to deployable ERT roster members when deployment is likely. Members indicate availability.
Standby	Standby (M2)	Team selected. Members prepare for departure, sign attestations, confirm readiness.

Dispatch	Dispatch (M3a)	Final composition confirmed. Pre-deployment briefing conducted. ERT physically departs, on-mission.
Stand Down	Stand Down (M3b)	Cancellation of Alert or Standby when deployment is no longer required.

Post-Mission Phases (POST-MISSION PHASES) use descriptive period references anchored to the planned end-of-mission date:

Phase	Description
Transition Planning	Begins in the last third of the deployment period. Handover plan developed jointly with NDMA.
Operational Handover	7 to 3 days before end of mission. Sector-specific transfers completed.
Demobilisation	Final 3 days. Phased withdrawal, asset reconciliation, individual debriefings.
After-Action Review	7 to 21 days after demobilisation. Analytical learning exercise.
Final Reporting	21 to 30 days after demobilisation. Mission report, archive, regional briefing.

ERT ACTIVATION AND MOBILISTAIOM — ERT Activation and Mobilisation

1. Purpose

This section establishes the procedure for activation and mobilisation of SADC Emergency Response Teams within the SHOC coordination framework. It provides guidance for the SHOC ERT Coordinator covering the full mobilisation cycle in alignment with the UNDAC Mission Cycle. Mobilisation shall be conducted in coordination with the designated NDMAs of affected Member States and in accordance with SHOC mandate parameters. All mobilisation processes are managed through the SHOC ERT Portal.

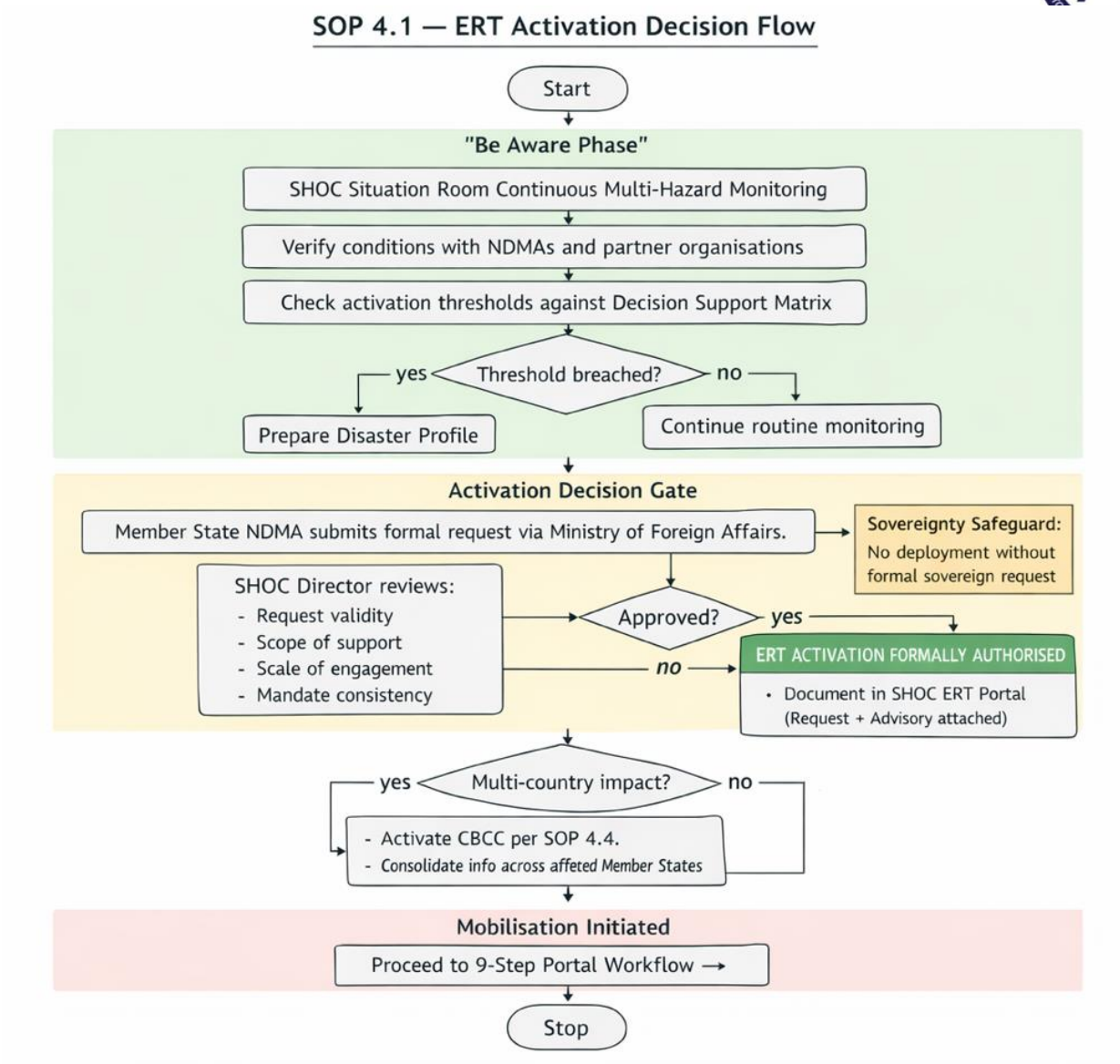
SHOC ERT COORDINATOR ACTION: This SOP is your primary operational reference for managing the end-to-end mobilisation process. You are responsible for all Portal transactions, liaison with NDMAs, roster management, travel clearances, and pre-deployment briefing coordination.

2. Scope and Applicability

This procedure governs mobilisation following a formally authorised activation. It applies to the SHOC ERT Coordinator, designated approving authorities, ERT Field Leads, rostered team members, and relevant SHOC operational personnel. Where activation involves requests from more than one Member State, the ERT Coordinator shall coordinate and consolidate information across affected states at each stage, with CBCC activation per TRANSBOUNDARY COOPERATION where applicable.

3. ERT Activation

ERT Activation is the formal decision authorising the initiation of Emergency Response Team mobilisation, representing a transition from Advisory to structured operational engagement.



4. Key Definitions

The following definitions are retained for operational clarity; however, in the consolidated edition they should be moved to an annexure or placed earlier in the document, and all acronyms should be fully defined on first use.

Term — Definition	
ERT	Emergency Response Team — a multi-disciplinary group of specialists rapidly deployed by SHOC to provide humanitarian assistance to disaster-affected Member States.
SHOC ERT Portal	The single digital platform hosted at sadc.int through which all ERT mobilisation transactions are managed. Analogous to UNDAC's VOSOCC.
Mobilisation	The systematic process of alerting, selecting, assembling, equipping, briefing, and dispatching ERT personnel. Covers the SHOC Mission Cycle phases: Watch, Alert, Standby, and Dispatch.
ERT Coordinator	The SHOC official (Head of Operations or designee) responsible for managing all mobilisation transactions via the SHOC ERT Portal.

Programme Officer Response	The SHOC officer responsible for day-to-day Portal management, roster updates, availability tracking and workflow processing.
ERT Field Lead	The designated team leader for the deployed ERT, responsible for field coordination, liaison with the NDMA EOC, and management of operations in-country.
NDMA DRR Focal Point	The national focal person (normally Head of NDMA or delegated authority) interfacing with the SHOC ERT Coordinator on mobilisation, reception, and coordination.
OSSHOC	On-Site SADC Humanitarian Operations Centre — the forward coordination hub established at the disaster site.
ICPs	International Cooperating Partners — including UN agencies, IFRC, bilateral donors, regional organisations, NGOs, and private sector entities.

The interoperability chain below is intended to clarify authority, decision flow, and operational interfaces during mobilisation. A future visual flowchart may present this chain more clearly than directional arrows in the table.

5. Mobilisation Interoperability Chain

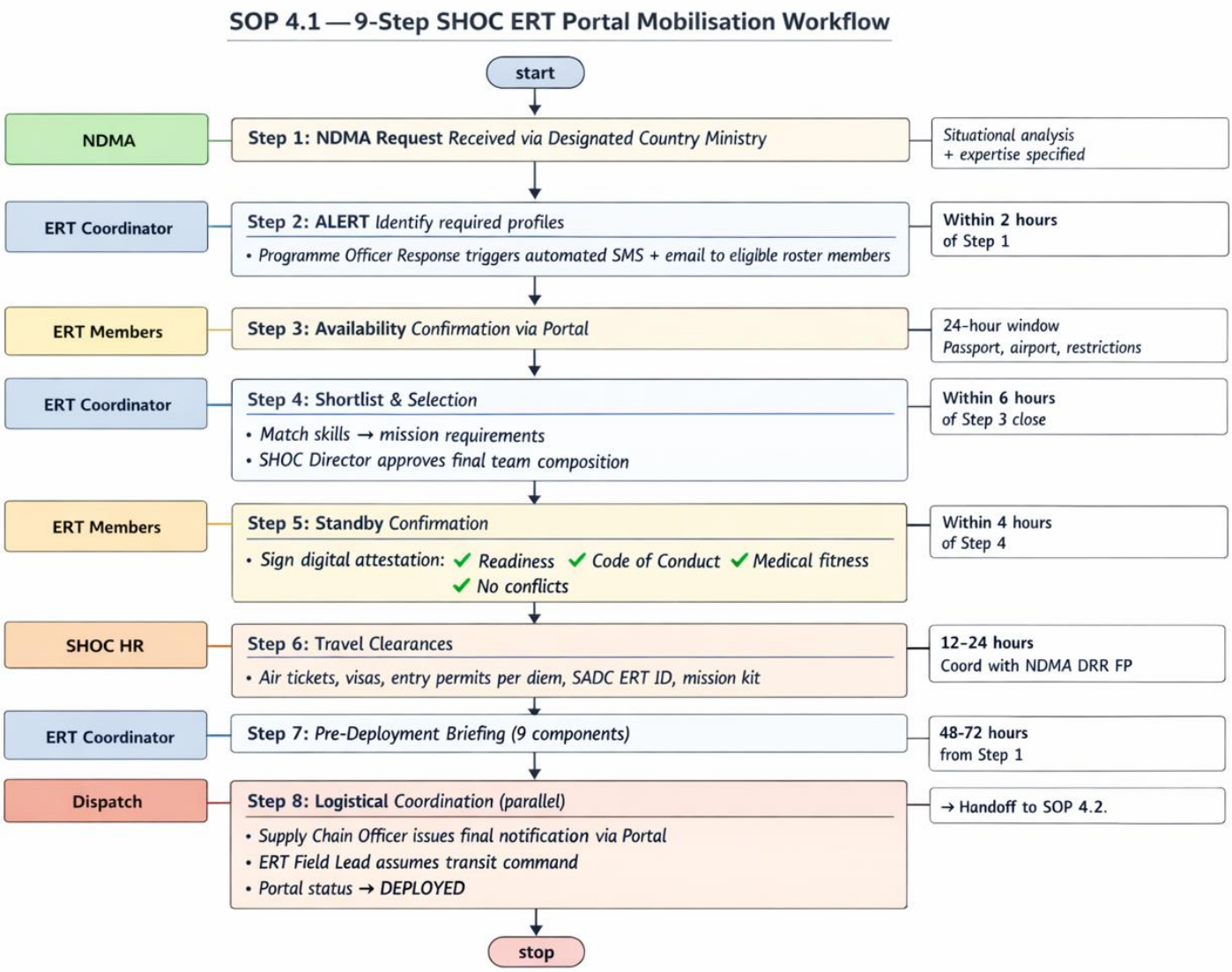
The following matrix defines the authority, responsibility, and communication chain. Each role interfaces with the SHOC ERT Portal.

The mobilisation workflow below should be revised from nine to ten steps in the next controlled version so that government request receipt, SHOC review, scope-of-support determination, team selection, and dispatch sequencing are more explicit.

Role	Authority	Key Mobilisation Actions	Reports To / Interfaces
SHOC Director	Strategic	Reviews request; determines scope of support; decides scale of engagement; chairs Pre-Deployment Briefing; interfaces with designated national authorities and SADC National Focal Points	SADC Secretariat; NDMA Director
ERT Coordinator	Operational	Manages proposed 10-step Portal workflow; selects team; arranges travel clearances; coordinates briefing logistics	SHOC Director ↑; ERT Field Lead ↓; NDMA DRR FP ↔
Programme Officer Response	Technical	Day-to-day Portal management; roster maintenance; availability tracking; dispatch documentation	ERT Coordinator ↑; Portal system
NDMA DRR Focal Point	National	Provides entry clearances; designates reception; confirms NDMA readiness; coordinates arrival logistics	Head of NDMA ↑; ERT Coordinator ↔
ERT Field Lead	Field Command	Confirms availability; leads team assembly; attends briefing; manages transit; assumes field coordination	ERT Coordinator (pre-deploy); NDMA Director (on arrival)
Situation Room Analysts	Intelligence	24/7 hazard monitoring; trigger assessment; disaster profiling; ongoing feeds	ERT Coordinator; SHOC Director
SHOC HR / Deployment Coord	Administrative	Books tickets; processes visas; arranges per diem; assembles mission kit	ERT Coordinator; ERT Field Lead
SHOC ERT COORDINATOR ACTION: You are the central node in the interoperability chain. Maintain direct communication with the NDMA DRR Focal Point from activation and brief the ERT Field Lead on the full chain before departure.			

6. SHOC ERT Portal Mobilisation Workflow

Every step corresponds to a Portal transaction. The 9-step workflow maps the complete mobilisation sequence from NDMA request through to ERT dispatch.



#	Transaction	Actions	Responsible	Timeline
1	Government Request	Formal request via designated NDMA and SADC National Focal Point, attaching situational analysis and specifying required expertise.	NDMA Director / Ministry	On receipt
2	**Alert**	ERT Coordinator identifies profiles. Programme Officer Response triggers automated notification to eligible roster members. Clear scope, duration, reporting requirements.	ERT Coordinator / POR	Within 2hr of Step 1
3	**Availability**	Roster members confirm/decline via Portal within 24hr. Captures: status, passport, airport, restrictions.	ERT Members / Portal	24hr from Alert

4	**Shortlist**	ERT Coordinator finalises team against competencies, geographic expertise, language requirements, and gender balance. SHOC Director determines scope of support and confirms engagement parameters.	ERT Coordinator / Director	Within 6hr of Step 3
5	**Standby**	Selected members receive standby notification. Sign attestation: readiness, Code of Conduct, medical fitness, no conflicts.	ERT Members / Coordinator	Within 4hr of Step 4
6	**Travel**	Air tickets, visas, entry permits, per diem, SADC ERT ID, mission kit assembly.	SHOC HR / NDMA DRR FP	12–24hr
7	**Briefing**	Mandatory 9-component briefing 2–4hr before departure. Chaired by SHOC Director or delegated authority. Portal records attendance and sign-off.	SHOC Director / Coordinator	2–4hr before departure
8	**Logistics**	Travel confirmation, SADC ERT ID, accommodation, comms setup, equipment. No dispatch without logistical confirmation.	ERT Coordinator / POR	Parallel to Step 7
9	**Dispatch**	Supply Chain Officer issues final notification via Portal. ERT Field Lead assumes transit command. Status → DEPLOYED. Handoff to IN- COUNTRY OPERATIONS PROTOCOL.	ERT Coordinator / Field Lead	48–72hr from Step 1

Stand Down: If the SHOC Director determines mobilisation is no longer required, the ERT Coordinator issues a stand-down notification via Portal. Stand-down reason recorded, member statuses reset to READY.

7. Mobilisation Phases

SHOC ERT COORDINATOR ACTION: Monitor Situation Room feeds. When threshold indicators approach activation levels, prepare preliminary disaster profile and verify NDMA DRR Focal Point contact details in the Portal.

7.2 Alert — Notification and Availability

On receipt of a formal NDMA request (Step 1), the ERT Coordinator assesses request completeness. The Programme Officer Response triggers automated alerts (Step 2). Members confirm availability within 24 hours (Step 3).

SHOC ERT COORDINATOR ACTION: Assess NDMA request completeness. If clarification needed, contact NDMA DRR Focal Point within 1 hour before triggering alert. Escalate if fewer than 80% respond within 24 hours.

7.3 Standby — Team Set-Up

The ERT Coordinator reviews availability, matches skills to mission requirements, and compiles team composition (Steps 4–6). The ERT Field Lead is formally appointed. SHOC Director approves. Selected members receive standby notification and sign attestation. SHOC HR processes travel clearances. The ERT Coordinator coordinates with the

NDMA DRR Focal Point for entry permits, reception, and logistics. A team set-up meeting is conducted by the ERT Field Lead.

7.4 Dispatch — Plan of Action and Deployment

The pre-deployment briefing is a control point for mission coherence, safety, interoperability, and accountability. It should also confirm translation arrangements, partner-interfacing expectations, and host-country reporting protocols before departure.

The SHOC Director chairs the mandatory Pre-Deployment Briefing (Section 8). The ERT Field Lead develops an initial mission framework identifying priority sectors and objectives. This serves as the basis for the Plan of Action, which is refined progressively in-country through joint NDMA assessment.

CRITICAL: The Plan of Action is a living document defined as the mission progresses. Team members develop an initial framework before arrival, but the operational PoA is shaped through joint assessment with the NDMA once in-country.

8. Pre-Deployment Briefing Protocol

Mandatory structured briefing 2–4 hours before ERT departure, chaired by SHOC Director. Via secure video conference or in-person at SHOC Situation Room, Nacala.

#	Component	Content	Delivered By	Duration
1	**Disaster Profile**	Hazard type, scale, geographic scope; affected population; myDEWETRA risk data; satellite imagery	Situation Room Analyst	15 min
2	**Operational Objectives**	Mission mandate; priority sectors; deployment timeline; KPIs; reporting schedule	ERT Coordinator	30 min
3	**Command Structure**	SHOC–NDMA–OSSHOC reporting lines; interoperability chain; ICP integration	ERT Coordinator	40 min
4	**Security**	UNDSS level; threat assessment; no-go zones; evacuation; medevac; insurance	Security FP	15 min
5	**Cultural / Legal**	Cultural protocols; language (EN/FR/PT); translation arrangements; legal framework; media rules; gender sensitivity	SHOC Director / PRO	20 min
6	**Logistics / Admin**	Travel; visa status; accommodation; per diem; comms equipment; IT access; mission kit	Deployment Coordinator	40 min
7	**Welfare / Duty of Care**	Stress management; psychosocial support; rotation policy; health; family contact	HR / Welfare Officer	30 min
8	**Conduct & Guidance**	Dress code, media protocol, contraband, Code of Conduct, PSEA, spouse declaration	SHOC Director / Coordinator	30 min
9	**Sign-Off**	Questions; formal sign-off on Briefing Record (Annex C); Mission Information Pack issued	Head of Operations	10 min

9. Pre-Deployment Conduct and Cautionary Guidance

Dress Code: SADC ERT uniform or SADC-branded attire. Visible SADC ERT ID. No military-style clothing.

Additional duty-of-care measures should include verification of insurance cover, medical self-declarations, blood group, medication requirements, psychosocial support needs, vaccination status, and emergency-contact details as part of the pre-deployment package.

Media Protocol: No media contact or social media posting. All enquiries to designated Media Focal Point.

Contraband: No unauthorised weapons, narcotics, excessive alcohol, or restricted currency. Luggage subject to ERT Field Lead inspection.

Code of Conduct / PSEA: SADC Code of Conduct and UN PSEA Bulletin (ST/SGB/2003/13). Exploitation/abuse = gross misconduct. Report to ERT Field Lead, NDMA Director, or SHOC Director.

The table below describes the core SHOC positions that enable emergency response management from the Situation Room and through field support functions.

10. Contact and Escalation Matrix

Narrative context is provided before the touchpoints table to support quick interpretation during live operations.

Problem	First Contact	Escalation	Portal Action
Mission order query	ERT Field Lead	Head of Operations	View mission order
Travel disruption	ERT Field Lead	ERT Coordinator	HR logs rebooking
Lost passport	ERT Field Lead	NDMA DRR Focal Point	Emergency ID via Portal

Security concern	ERT Field Lead	Security FP → SHOC Director	Security incident report
Medical emergency	ERT Field Lead	HR/Welfare → SHOC Director	Medevac protocol
PSEA complaint	ERT Field Lead	NDMA Director or SHOC Director	Confidential channel
Disagreement with NDMA	ERT Field Lead	ERT Coordinator → Head of Ops	Log in 72-Hour Review
Equipment failure	ERT Field Lead	ERT Coordinator	Logistics request
Personal welfare	ERT Field Lead	Head of Operations	Welfare log (confidential)

11. SHOC Staffing Model for Emergency Response

Core SHOC Positions		
#	**Position**	**SOP Assignment**
1	**SHOC Director (ED)**	Chairs Briefing; Chairs AAR; Approves activation; Strategic NDMA engagement
2	**Deputy Director**	Deputises for Director; chairs briefing when Director unavailable
3	**Head of Operations (ERT Coordinator)**	Manages proposed 10-step workflow; co-leads 72-Hour Review; oversees demobilisation
4	**Head of Programmes**	Programme coordination; capacity building; training curriculum
5	**Programme Officer Response**	Day-to-day Portal; roster maintenance; availability tracking; dispatch docs
6–9	**Situation Room Analysts (x4)**	24/7 monitoring; myDEWETRA; disaster profiling; data feeds
10	**Logistics / Supply Chain Officer**	Dispatch notification; logistics briefing; asset reconciliation
11	**Information Management Officer**	SitRep compilation; GIS; dashboard; data transfer at Close-Out
12	**Communications / ICT Officer**	Comms equipment; ICT infrastructure; data security
13	**Finance / Admin Officer**	Financial tracking; procurement; allowances; insurance
14	**Training / Capacity Building**	ERT training; SIMEX planning; training needs from AAR
15	**Security Focal Point**	Security briefing; UNDSS liaison; evacuation planning
16	**HR / Welfare Officer**	Welfare briefing; personnel welfare; psychosocial support
17	**M&E Officer**	Performance data; Pre-Deployment attendance; M&E reporting
18	**Deployment Coordinator**	Travel logistics; visa facilitation; admin briefing
19	**Translators (EN/FR/PT)**	Language support across all operations

Specialist Sector Teams (10–20): 48–72hr mobilisation. WASH, shelter, protection, SAR, camp management, IM. 14–42 days, mandatory rotation after 21.

12. Cross-SOP Touchpoints

Activity	Link	Interface	Mechanism
ERT Dispatch	4.2	Arrival triggers reception	Dispatch notification; IN- COUNTRY OPERATIONS PROTOCOL Phase 1
OSSHOC Establishment	4.2	Joint coordination meetings	ERT Field Lead coordinates with NDMA EOC
Transboundary Hazard	4.4	Cross-border impact	CBCC activation in Pre-Deployment Briefing

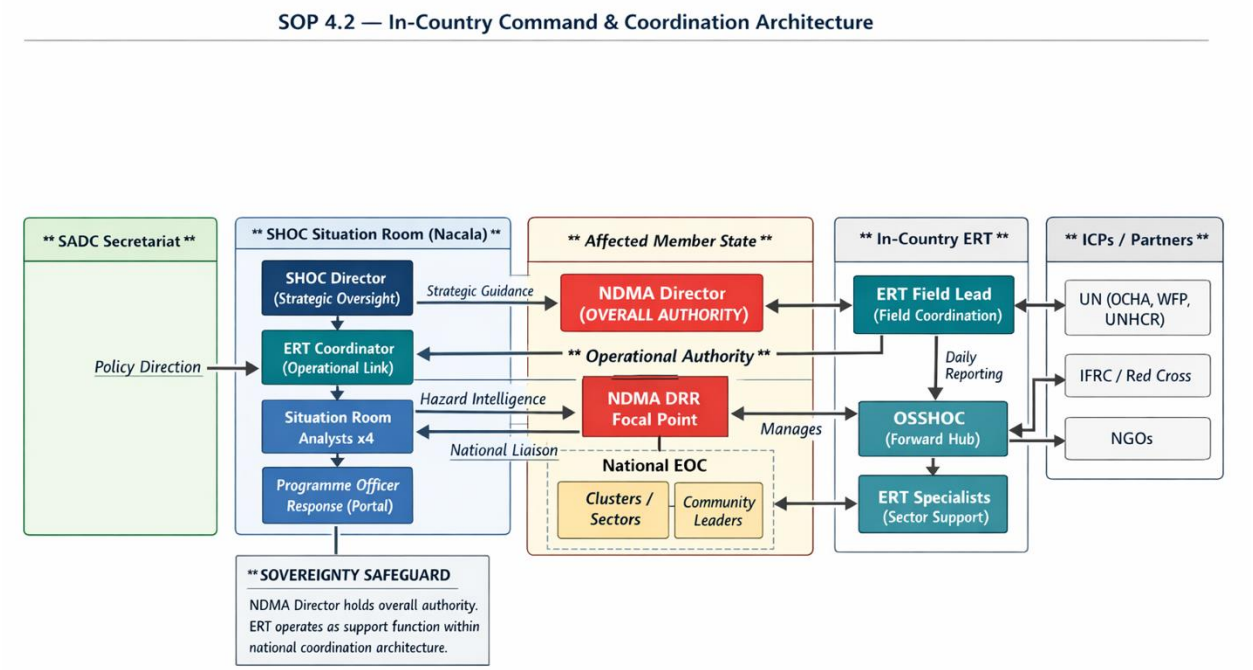
Mission Completion	4.3	Transition criteria met	SHOC Director and NDMA jointly confirm

IN- COUNTRY OPERATIONS PROTOCOL — In-Country Operations Protocol

1. Purpose

This SOP establishes standardised procedures for SADC ERT operations upon arrival in a disaster-affected Member State. It governs reception, integration into national coordination structures, joint assessment, reporting, information management, community engagement, and — where a disaster affects multiple Member States — transboundary coordination protocols. It also provides mechanisms for activating the CBCC, establishing National Cross-Border Desks, facilitating joint assessments and shared logistics corridors, and ensuring harmonised information exchange.

2. Command and Coordination Structure



SOVEREIGNTY SAFEGUARD: Operational command remains fully under the NDMA Director at all times. The ERT operates under the overall authority of the affected Member State's NDMA Director. SHOC provides strategic oversight from the Situation Room; the ERT Coordinator maintains the operational link.

3. Scope and Applicability

Applies to all SHOC-deployed ERT members, NDMA personnel, ICPs, NGOs, UN agencies (OCHA, WFP, UNHCR), IFRC, and any organisation within the SADC response. Activated upon ERT arrival, in force until handover and transition to POST-MISSION PHASES. Mandated under Article 6 of the SHOC Intergovernmental Memorandum of Agreement (SADC Summit, August 2022, Kinshasa).

4. Roles and Responsibilities

SHOC Secretariat provides strategic oversight, resource allocation, Situation Room monitoring, Portal management, and SADC Secretariat communication.

The following time thresholds indicate the expected maximum time within which critical in-country actions should be initiated or completed, subject to host-country conditions and security constraints.

NDMA (Affected State) retains overall disaster response authority. Directs ERT integration, provides operational direction, approves public information, leads joint assessments.

The procedural phases below should be read as a practical progression for field operations. Where conditions change rapidly, the ERT Field Lead and NDMA may compress, overlap, or accelerate phases while maintaining accountability.

ERT Field Lead manages daily coordination, NDMA/EOC liaison, operational reporting, OSSHOC management, and ERT security/welfare.

ERT Members provide technical sector support, cluster coordination, data collection and reporting.

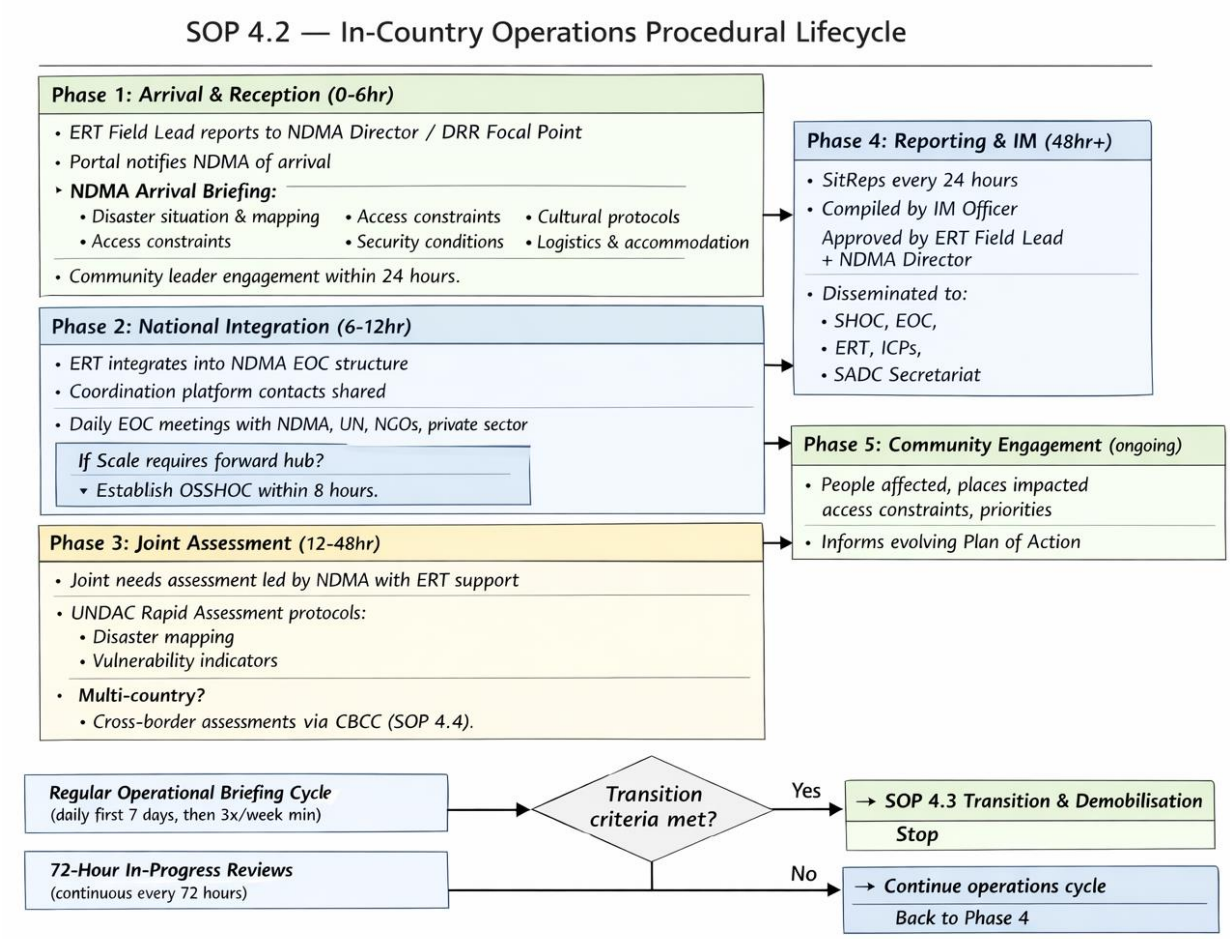
ICPs / NGOs / Private Sector provide complementary resources, technical expertise, logistics, cluster coordination, capacity building.

Accountability: NDMA accountable for reception, EOC integration, daily briefings, escalation. SHOC Ops accountable for assessment planning and SitRep preparation. ERT Field Lead responsible for executing reception, integration, assessments, briefings, and reports.

5. Time Thresholds for Critical Actions

Action	Responsible	Time Frame
NDMA briefs ERT on arrival	NDMA / DRR Focal Point	Within 6 hours
Integration into EOC clusters	NDMA / ERT Field Lead	Within 12 hours
Community leader engagement	ERT Field Lead / NDMA	Within 24 hours
First Joint Assessment	ERT and Clusters	Within 48 hours
First SitRep to SHOC	IM Officer / ERT Field Lead	Within 72 hours / 24–48hr thereafter
Daily Coordination Meetings	NDMA Chair	Every 24 hours or as per roster
72-Hour In-Progress Review	ERT Field Lead / Coordinator	Every 72 hours

6. Procedural Phases



Phase 1: Arrival and Reception (0–6 hours)

ERT Field Lead reports to NDMA Director or DRR Focal Point. Portal notifies NDMA/EOC of arrival. NDMA Arrival Briefing covers: disaster situation, access constraints, security, cultural protocols, logistics, key contacts. Community leader engagement within 24 hours.

Phase 2: Integration into National Coordination (6–12 hours)

ERT integrates into national EOC structure. Coordination platform contacts shared. Daily EOC meetings with NDMA, UN, NGOs, private sector. OSSHOC established within 8 hours if required.

Phase 3: Joint Assessment and Operations (12–48 hours)

Joint needs assessments led by NDMA with ERT support within 48 hours. UNDAC Rapid Assessment protocols: disaster mapping, vulnerability indicators, satellite imagery. For multi-country disasters, cross-border assessments via CBCC per TRANSBOUNDARY COOPERATION.

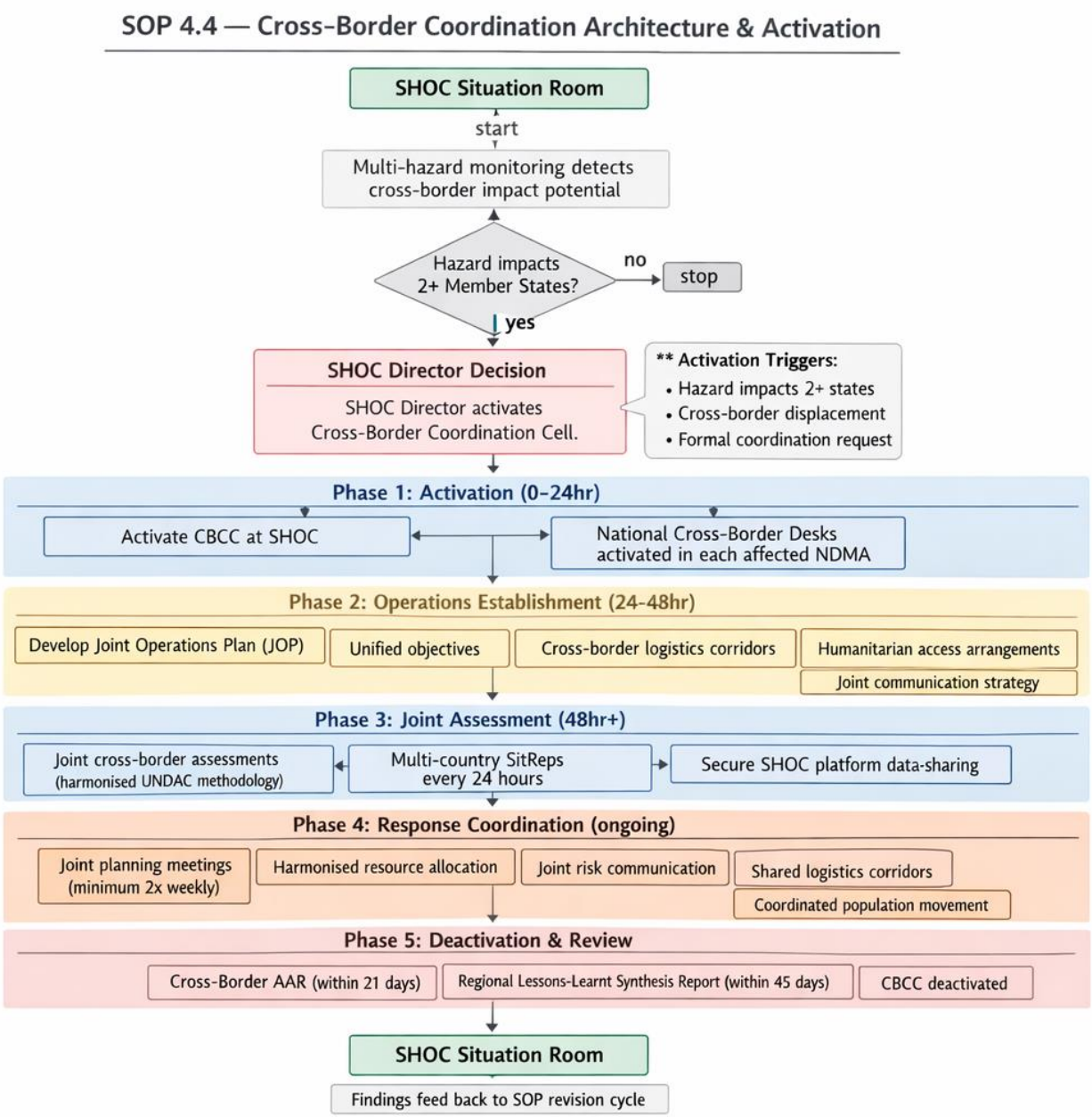
Phase 4: SITREPS (24 hours)

SitReps every 24 hours, compiled by IM Officer, approved by ERT Field Lead in consultation with NDMA Director. Disseminated to SHOC, EOC, ERT, ICPs, SADC Secretariat. Multi-country SitReps via harmonised formats where applicable.

Phase 5: Community and Local Engagement (ongoing)

ERT Field Lead engages community representatives during NDMA arrival briefing. Information: people affected, places impacted, access constraints, priorities. Informs evolving Plan of Action. SHOC coordinates logistics dispatch based on findings.

Phase 6: Transboundary Coordination (if applicable)



CBCC: Activated by SHOC Director when impacts span multiple states. National Cross-Border Desks within 24 hours.

Joint Operations Plan: Within 48 hours. Unified objectives, cross-border logistics corridors, humanitarian access, joint communication.

Joint Planning: Minimum 2x weekly. Harmonised resource allocation, risk communication, shared corridors, population movement coordination.

Data Sharing: Secure SHOC platforms, harmonised formats.

7. Regular Operational Briefing Cycle

The following touchpoints align in-country operations with mobilisation, transition, and transboundary procedures so that information flows, handovers, and escalation decisions remain joined-up.

Mandatory coordination mechanism from first full day after arrival until transition planning (POST-MISSION PHASES).

Frequency: Daily first 7 days (default 08:00 local). NDMA Director may adjust to 3x/week minimum after initial phase.

Duration: 30–45 min standard; 15 min shortened format for reduced tempo.

Standard Agenda: (1) Overnight Situation Update; (2) Sector/Cluster Reports; (3) Logistics; (4) Security; (5) Coordination Issues; (6) Priority Actions; (7) Welfare Check.

Attendance recorded using Operational Briefing Roster Template (Annex AM), uploaded to Portal within 2 hours. Cumulative records feed 72-Hour Reviews.

8. 72-Hour In-Progress Operational Review

Structured review every 72 hours throughout deployment, linking field operations to strategic decision-making. Covers: operational progress, resource/logistics status, personnel welfare, partner coordination, escalation decisions, updated reporting. Conducted by ERT Field Lead and ERT Coordinator.

9. Cross-SOP Touchpoints

The phases below govern the shift from active emergency operations to orderly national handover, demobilisation, learning capture, and final reporting.

Transition, Demobilisation and Post-Mission Reporting

1. Purpose

This SOP provides procedures for orderly transition from SADC ERT operations to sustained national recovery, phased demobilisation, post-mission reporting, After-Action Review, individual performance evaluation, and knowledge management.

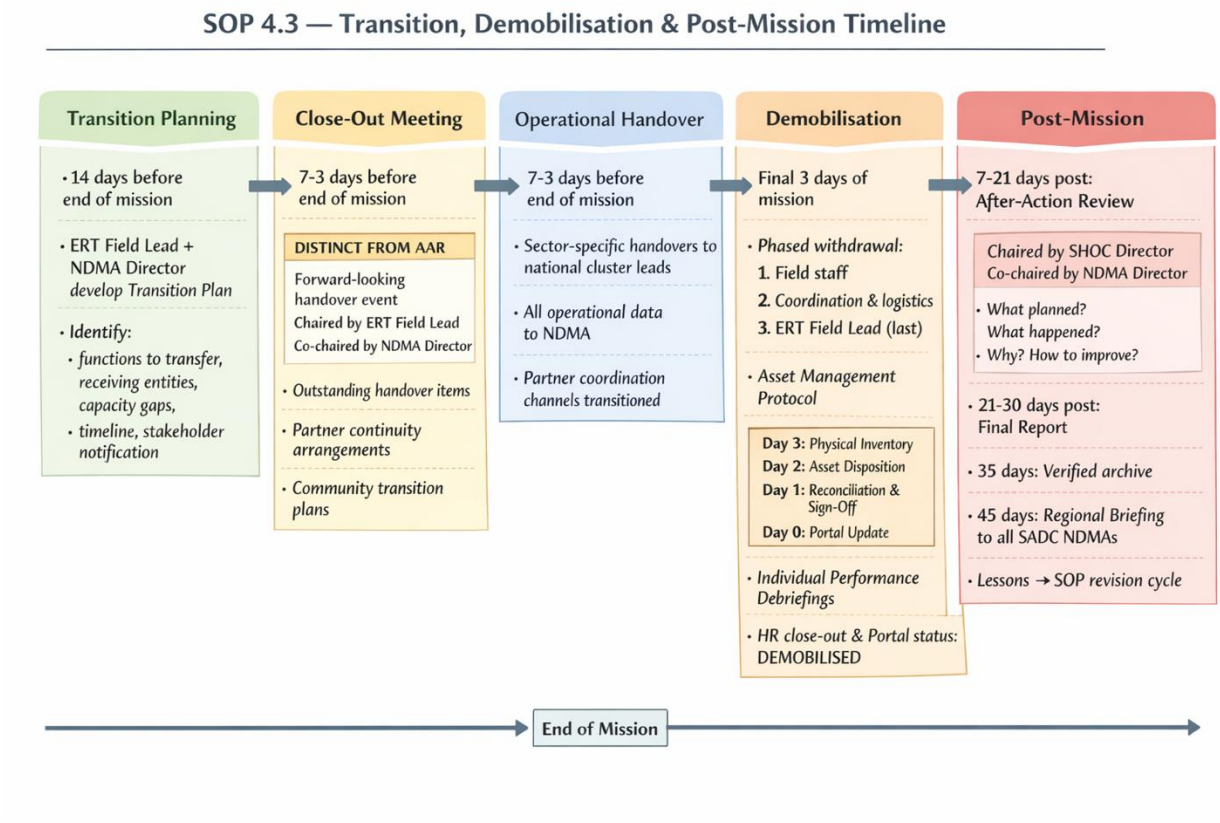
2. Scope

Applies to all ERT members, NDMA counterparts, ICPs, NGOs, private sector, and SHOC personnel. Covers activities from SHOC Director's determination that national capacity can sustain operations through to final archiving.

3. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Transition	Demobilisation	Post-Mission
SHOC Director	Approves transition plan	Authorises demobilisation	Chairs AAR; approves final report
ERT Coordinator	Manages timeline; coordinates handover	Oversees withdrawal; HR close-out; Portal	Consolidates lessons; updates roster
ERT Field Lead	Leads planning with NDMA; chairs close-out	Manages field demob; individual debriefs	Drafts mission report; leads field AAR
NDMA Director	Confirms readiness for full control	Verifies handover completion	Co-chairs AAR; endorses lessons

4. Procedural Phases



Close-Out Meeting (distinct from AAR)

CRITICAL: The Close-Out Meeting is an operational handover event (forward-looking, chaired by ERT Field Lead), fundamentally different from the After-Action Review (backward-looking, chaired by SHOC Director after demobilisation). The SADC SHOC model formally separates these processes.

Conducted 7–3 days before end of mission. Chaired by ERT Field Lead, co-chaired by NDMA Director. Addresses outstanding handover items, partner continuity, community transition.

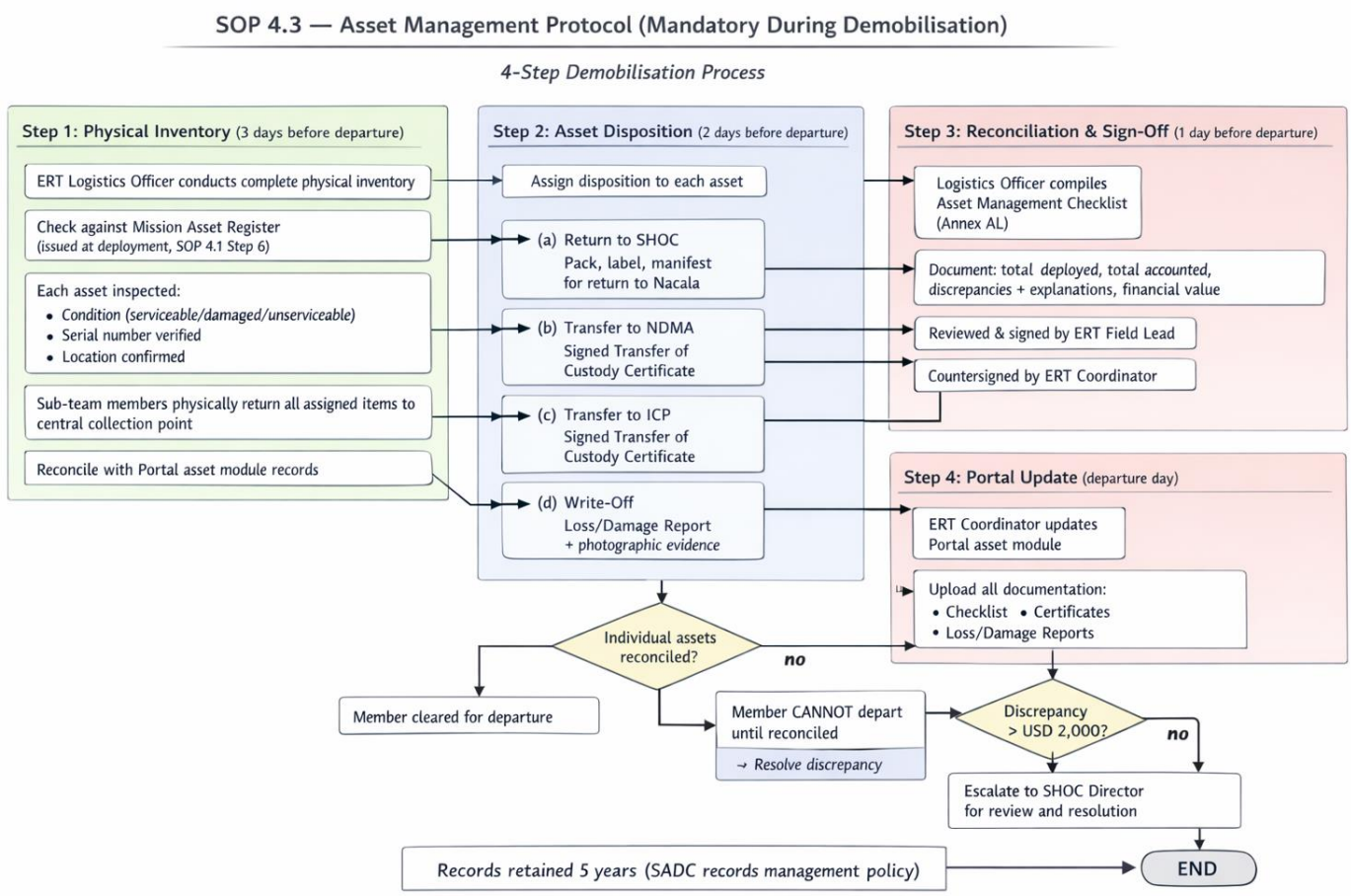
Phase 2: Operational Handover (7–3 days before end of mission)

Sector-specific handovers to national cluster leads. All data, assessments, contact databases transferred to NDMA. Partner coordination channels formally transitioned.

Phase 3: Demobilisation (final 3 days)

Phased withdrawal: field staff first, coordination/logistics second, ERT Field Lead last. Performance debriefings conducted. HR close-out: allowances, insurance, welfare referrals. Portal status → DEMOBILISED.

Asset Management Protocol (mandatory)



Step 1 — Physical Inventory (3 days before): Complete inventory against Mission Asset Register. Condition, serial numbers, location. Reconcile with Portal.

Step 2 — Asset Disposition (2 days before): (a) Return to SHOC; (b) Transfer to NDMA; (c) Transfer to ICP; (d) Write-Off; (e) Consumable Depletion.

Step 3 — Reconciliation (1 day before): Checklist (Annex AL) compiled, signed by Field Lead, countersigned by Coordinator. No departure until reconciled.

Step 4 — Portal Update (departure day): Portal updated. Documentation uploaded. Finance reconciles within 14 days. Discrepancies >USD 2,000 → SHOC Director.

Phase 4: After-Action Review (7–21 days post-demobilisation)

Analytical learning exercise: What Planned? What Happened? Why? How to Improve? Chaired by SHOC Director, co-chaired by NDMA Director. Outputs: AAR Report (Annex S), Lessons Learned Register (Annex I), SOP revision recommendations. For transboundary deployments, Cross-Border AAR within 21 days and Regional Synthesis within 45 days.

Phase 5: Individual ERT Performance Evaluation

End-of-mission evaluation (final 48 hours). 5-point scale, IASC Humanitarian Competency Framework: Technical (30%), Coordination (25%), Communication (20%), Professional Conduct (15%), Adaptability (10%).

Score linkage: 4.0+ = priority; 3.0–3.9 = standard; <3.0 = improvement plan; <2.0 = remedial. Nominating NDMA formally notified when eligibility affected.

Phase 6: Final Reporting (21–30 days post-demobilisation)

Final Mission Report within 30 days. Verified archive within 35 days. Regional Briefing within 45 days for all SADC NDMAs.

TRANSBOUNDARY COOPERATION — Transboundary Cooperation

1. Purpose

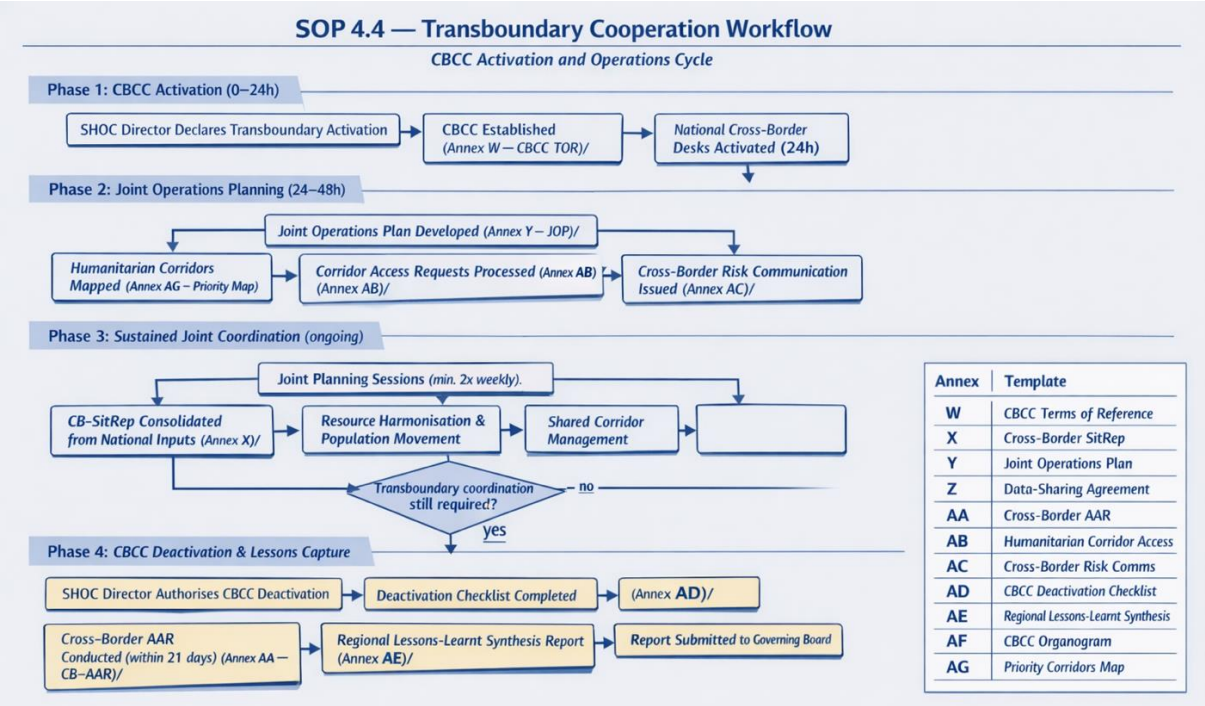
2. Scope and Applicability

Applies when the SHOC Director determines that an emergency spans or threatens multiple SADC Member States. Covers all ERT personnel, National Cross-Border Desks, NDMA counterparts, and partner organisations operating in affected border zones. Activated in conjunction with IN- COUNTRY OPERATIONS PROTOCOL Phase 6 and remains operative until CBCC deactivation (Annex AD).

3. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
SHOC Director	Declares transboundary activation; activates CBCC; approves JOP; authorises deactivation
CBCC Chair	Chairs joint planning sessions; manages CB-SitRep consolidation; coordinates humanitarian corridor access
National Cross-Border Desks	Established within 24 hours; provide national situation inputs; manage local corridor logistics
ERT Field Leads	Feed national operations data to CBCC; execute JOP at country level; lead country-level CB-AAR

4. Operational Phases



Phase 1 — CBCC Activation (0–24 hours): SHOC Director declares transboundary activation. CBCC established per Annex W (CBCC TOR). National Cross-Border Desks activated in each affected state. CBCC Organogram (Annex AF) issued. Data-Sharing Agreement (Annex Z) signed by all parties.

Phase 2 — Joint Operations Planning (24–48 hours): Joint Operations Plan developed per Annex Y. Humanitarian corridors mapped against Priority Corridors Map (Annex AG); access requests processed via Annex AB. Initial Cross-Border Risk Communication issued per Annex AC.

Phase 3 — Sustained Joint Coordination (ongoing): Joint planning sessions minimum 2x weekly. CB-SitRep (Annex X) consolidated from national inputs. Resource harmonisation, population movement coordination, and shared corridor management.

Phase 4 — CBCC Deactivation and Lessons Capture: SHOC Director authorises deactivation when transboundary coordination no longer required. Deactivation Checklist (Annex AD) completed. Cross-Border AAR (Annex AA) conducted within 21 days. Regional Lessons-Learnt Synthesis (Annex AE) submitted to Governing Board.

5. Cross-SOP Touchpoints

TRANSBOUNDARY COOPERATION interfaces with: ERT ACTIVATION AND MOBILISATION (transboundary triggers flagged in Pre-Deployment Briefing), IN- COUNTRY OPERATIONS PROTOCOL Phase 6 (in-country transboundary coordination feeds CBCC), POST-MISSION PHASES (CB-AAR integrates with national AAR cycle; CBCC deactivation precedes or coincides with mission demobilisation). Communication Security Protocol (Annex AH) applies to all cross-border communications.

— END OF SOPS—

Annex: Communication Security Protocol

Priority 1 (Critical): Radio, satellite phones, secure encrypted systems — mission-critical.

Priority 2 (Routine): Email, video conference, WhatsApp, Slack — coordination and SitRep dissemination.

Priority 3 (General): Telephone, SMS — non-urgent and administrative.

All sensitive communications encrypted. Access limited to authorised personnel. Communication in English, French, or Portuguese with translator support.

Complete Annexes Index

Annex	Title	SOP
A	ERT Mobilisation Checklist	4.1
B	Team Readiness Evaluation Form	4.1
C	Pre-Deployment Briefing Record	4.1
D	Travel and Entry Clearance Tracker	4.1
E	Demobilisation Inventory and Handover	4.3
F	Close-Out Meeting Minutes Template	4.3
G	Individual ERT Performance Evaluation	4.3
H–I	After-Action Report Template; Lessons Learned Capture	4.3
J–P	In-Country: Integration Checklist, EOC Contacts, SitRep, Joint Assessment, OSSHOC, Risk Log, Community Engagement	4.2
Q–V	Handover, End-of-Mission, AAR, Financial, Knowledge, Close-Out	4.3
W–AG	Transboundary: CBCC TOR, CB-SitRep, JOP, Data-Sharing, CB-AAR, Corridors, Risk Comms, Deactivation, Lessons, Organogram, Priority Map	4.4
AH	Communication Security Protocol	All
AI–AK	Mission Info Pack; Contact/Escalation Card; Field Lead Checklist	4.1
AL	Asset Management and Reconciliation Checklist	4.3
AM	Operational Briefing Roster Template	4.2

Review and Revision

Biennial review, or earlier if triggered by: major deployment gaps; SADC governance changes; UNDAC/IFRC/AHA Centre updates; AAR recommendations; Hosting Agreement/MoA changes. Review: SHOC Director with Governing Board.

Next scheduled review: 01 July 2028.

— END OF SOPs—